

4.2 What students need to learn

1 Overview	Students should be encouraged to develop their performance skills further by playing a range of styles of music as a soloist and/or an ensemble member, using scores or improvising as appropriate. For assessment purposes, students are expected to perform for 12-15 minutes, considerably longer than for Unit 1, by presenting a balanced, coherent programme of music.
2 Performance from a score	In all their performing, students should continue to aim for accuracy of pitch and rhythm, for accurate observation of phrasing, articulation, dynamics and tempo, for fluency and a sense of style. They should be striving for greater technical assurance than in Unit 1 and for greater maturity of style, interpretation and communication.
3 Improvised performance	Students who choose to improvise should continue to aim for accuracy in playing or singing a chosen stimulus, and for fluency. They should strive for greater technical assurance than in Unit 1, and for greater maturity of style, interpretation and communication. They should work to develop skills in exploiting and developing a chosen stimulus.
4 Ensemble performance	Students who choose to perform in an ensemble should continue to aim for the same high standards of accuracy, technique and interpretation required of solo performers. In addition, they should demonstrate ensemble skills, with an awareness of balance and the ability to react and adjust to other parts.
5 Planning a performance programme	Students should also learn about what makes a well-balanced, varied but coherent musical programme. They should apply this knowledge when planning their final assessed performance.